

SARAH ASHCROFT-JONES

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EDUCATION

The Queen's College, University of Oxford

Oct 2019 - Nov 2023

DPhil in Experimental Psychology, Oxford ACCLab

Funded by the MRC DTP

Thesis: "Exploring metacognitive confidence in categorisation judgements"

St. Cross College, University of Oxford

Oct 2018 - Sept 2019

MSc in Psychological Research

Humphrey Prize for Best Research Dissertation

Thesis: "Computing confidence: the role of category representation and perceptual uncertainty"

St. John's College, University of Cambridge

Oct 2014 - Jun 2017

MA Cantab in Psychological and Behavioural Sciences

The Cambridge Double First

Scholar of St. John's, Alfred Hall Prior Scholarship, Wright Prize

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Columbia University, Mailman School of Public Health

Postdoctoral Researcher - Health Policy & Management

Nov 16th 2023 - Feb 1st 2025

Associate Research Scientist - Health Policy & Management

Feb 1st 2025 - Present

- Researching the individual and structural factors that influence financial and health behaviours.
- Leveraging the positive deviance framework to test effective interventions to reduce social inequality.
- Responsibilities include research design, quantitative analytics, and statistical programming.
- Working with community health stakeholders, policy advisors, and interdisciplinary research groups.
- Responsible for innovative fintech intervention research in collaboration with SaverLife to reduce financial inequality in a real-world setting.

Cambridge University

Oct 2024 - Present

Research Associate - Centre for Business Research, Judge Business School

- Organising annual international behavioural research projects spanning multiple countries.
- Responsible for the logistical coordination of a three-week research stay for almost 40 researchers.
- Liaising with Corpus Christi, Judge Business, and the JRP to coordinate.

World Bank Group

Oct 2022 - Nov 2023

Research Consultant - Mind, Behavior & Development Unit

- Systematic review and meta-review coding of the Behavioural Science of the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Research reviews to inform policymakers and communicate intervention design to government bodies.
- Responsible for producing timely and audience sensitive research outputs.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Judgment and decision-making, behavioral economics, metacognition, bounded rationality

PUBLICATIONS

van den Akker, O. R., Bakker, M., van Assen, M. A., Pennington, C. R., Verweij, L., Elsherif, M. M., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., ... & Wicherts, J. M. The potential of preregistration in psychology: Assessing preregistration producibility and preregistration-study consistency. *Psychological Methods* (2024)

DOI: 10.1037/met0000687

Ruggeri, K., Stock, F., Haslam, S.A., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., ... *et al.* A synthesis of evidence for policy from behavioural science during COVID-19. *Nature* (2023).

DOI: 10.1038/s41586-023-06840-9

Ashcroft-Jones, S., Ruggeri, K., Abate Romero Landini, G. *et al.* The persistence of cognitive biases in financial decisions across economic groups. *Sci Rep* 13, 10329, (2023).

DOI: 10.1038/s41598-023-36339-2

Ruggeri, K., Tutuska, O.S., ... & Ashcroft-Jones, S. The psychology and policy of overcoming economic inequality. *Behavioural and Brain Sciences*, (2023).

DOI: 10.1017/S0140525X23001103

Pownall, M., Azevedo, F., König, L. M., Slack, H. R., Evans, T. R., Flack, Z., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., ... & FORRT. Teaching open and reproducible scholarship: a critical review of the evidence base for current pedagogical methods and their outcomes. *Royal Society Open Science*, 10(5), 221255, (2023).

DOI: 10.1098/rsos.221255

Buabang, E.K., Ashcroft-Jones, S., Esteban Serna, C., Kastelic, K., Kveder, J., Lambertus, A., Müller, T. S. Validation and Measurement Invariance of the Personal Financial Wellness Scale: A Multinational Study in 7 Countries, *European Journal of Psychological Assessment*, (2022).

DOI: 10.1027/1015-5759/a000750

Parsons, S., Azevedo, F., Elsherif, M.M., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., ... *et al.* A community-sourced glossary of open scholarship terms, *Nat Hum Behav.* (2022).

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-021-01269-4

Ruggeri, K., Panin, A., Vdovic, M., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., ... *et al.* The globalizability of temporal discounting. *Nat Hum Behav*, (2022).

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-022-01392-w

Ruggeri, K., Većkalov, B., Bojanić, L., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., ... *et al.* The general fault in our fault lines. *Nat Hum Behav*, (2021).

DOI: 10.1038/s41562-021-01092-x

Eckstein, M., Zietlow, A., Gerchen, M.F., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., ... *et al.*, The NeMo real-time fMRI neurofeedback study: protocol of a randomised controlled clinical intervention trial in the neural foundations of mother–infant bonding, *BMJ Open*, (2019).

DOI: 10.1136/bmjopen-2018-027747

WORKING PAPERS & MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Ashcroft-Jones, S., Buabang, E., Müller, T., Ruggeri, K. Subjective financial strain, not the poverty line, as strongest predictor of temporal discounting across 6 countries. *Manuscript in preparation for submission to Behavioral Public Policy*.

Ruggeri, K., Valenzuela-Catarí, G., Polemiti, E., Abderahaman, G., Adawi, T. R., Agopian, T., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., Pelica. Global well-being in 2025: A multidimensional analysis of mental, financial, and social health in 92 countries. *under review* (2025)
Preprint DOI: 10.31234/osf.io/3jydav1

Kovacs, L. N., Ashcroft-Jones, S., Schmidt, J., Geiger, S., ... Kokonyei, G. Loss-and gain-framed messages alter climate emotions, but not behaviour across 26 countries. *under review, Nature Communications* (2025)
Preprint DOI: 10.31234/osf.io/4kqamv1

Stock, F., Pelica, S., Ashcroft-Jones, S., Stablum, F., Acosta, C., Aimable, A., *et al.* People in 26 countries prefer individual control to commercial or governmental control over online choice architectures *under review, Nature Communication* (2025)
Preprint DOI: 10.31219/osf.io/haqu9

Yaoi, Q., Ashcroft-Jones, S., Pei, S., Ruggeri, K. Person, place, or preference? Combining subjective and objective decision agency with choice preferences predicts behavior during major shifts in human mobility. *under review, HSSC* (2025)
Preprint DOI: 0.1101/2025.09.08.25335351

Azevedo, F., Friedel, E., Ashcroft-Jones, S., Korbmacher, M., Lloyd, K., Mudahera, D. R., Kravesta, A., Resulbegoviq, H., Andreolli, G., Micheli, L., P. Silverstein. How to Develop and Use Open Educational Resources. *Book Chapter, publication forthcoming* (2025)
Preprint DOI: 10.35542/osf.io/sn693v2

Ruggeri, K., ... Ashcroft-Jones, S., Stock, F. Financial decision-making, income, cognitive biases: The impact of economic systems and environments on behavior in six countries. (2024).
Preprint DOI:10.31219/osf.io/f8hyk

AWARDS & GRANTS

2025	Best Poster at MPI for Human Development, Berlin (~ \$500)
2022	UKRI Research Stay at Cambridge (~ \$3500)
2021	UKRI COVID DTP Studentship Extension (~ \$7500)
2019	UKRI Medical Research Council DTP Studentship (3 years) (~ \$75000)
2019	The Humphrey Dissertation Prize (~ \$200)
2017	Alfred Hall Prior Scholarships & Write Prizes (~ \$2500)

POSTERS & PRESENTATIONS

Ashcroft-Jones, S., & Ruggeri, K. “Personalized, simple defaults to optimize financial decisions in a digital budgeting tool, a pre-test”

Poster: Max Planck Institute for Human Development, Berlin, June 2025

Ashcroft-Jones, S. “Behavioural Science in health and financial research.”

Presentation: UCL Behavioural Innovations Society, London, January 2025

Ashcroft-Jones, S. & Ruggeri, K. “Personalized, simple defaults using a positive deviance approach to optimize financial decisions.”

Poster: Society of Judgement and Decision Making, New York, November 2024

Ashcroft-Jones, S., “Open Science & Reproducibility: A practical introduction & a personal perspective.”

Presentation: MRC DTP Discussion Forum, Oxford, April 2023

Ashcroft-Jones, S. & Yeung, N., “Decision Confidence: Exploring the Distance-to-Bound Model of Confidence.”

Poster: ICPS, Brussels, March 2023

Ashcroft-Jones, S., “A multinational study exploring the relationship between poverty, stress, financial literacy, and decision making.”

Presentation: JRPC, Cambridge, August 2022

Ashcroft-Jones, S. & Yeung, N., “Decision confidence is sensitive to both distribution variance and distance to the category bound.”

Poster: MRC DTP Symposium, Oxford, June & JRP Open Conference, Siena, July 2022

Ashcroft-Jones, S., “Category information and confidence sensitivity: Beyond distance to bound.”

Presentation: Experimental Psychology DPhil Seminar Series, Oxford, May 2022

Ashcroft-Jones, S., “Open Science & Reproducibility: A practical introduction.”

Presentation: MRC DTP Discussion Forum, Oxford, March 2022

Ashcroft-Jones, S., Calder-Travis, J., & Yeung, N., “Computing Decision Confidence: The role of category membership and perceptual uncertainty.”

Poster: JRPC, Cambridge, August 2019: <https://osf.io/7vwb4>

Buabang, E.K., Ashcroft-Jones, S., Esteban Serna, C., Kastelic, K., Kveder, J., Lambertus, A., & Müller, T. S., “The poverty trap: A multinational study examining the relationship between poverty, decision making, stress, and well-being.”

Poster: UFV Madrid JRP Meeting, Madrid, March 2019: <https://osf.io/f5k6c>

RESEARCH SKILLS

Programming Skills	R, Python, MatLab, JavaScript, HTML, CSS.
Software & Tools	L ^A T _E X, RMarkdown, JASP, Tableau, SPSS, NVivo, ATLAS.
Computational Training	ASSP 2024, ESS Bayesian Analysis, SysMIC Module 1 (Hons).
Languages	English (C2), Irish (C1), German (B2), French (A2), Japanese (A2).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Columbia University - Lecturer *April 2022 - Present*

Program Director - Global Behavioral Science - GLOBES (Fall Semester 2024 - Present):

- Coordinating an overseas research stay at the University of Cambridge in the behavioural sciences.
- Co-leading a research project across country borders, supervising and teaching core research skills.
- Responsibilities included budget acquisition, research oversight, and logistic coordination.

Course Lead - Computing in Context using Python (Fall Semester 2024 - Present):

- Leading a skills-based graduate course on Python and its applications to the health policy context.
- Combining practical labs and theoretical lectures to build student analytic acumen.
- Establishing curriculum, assignments, and grading for Public Health Context.

Course Lead - Graduate Analytics Course in Public Health (Jan 2024 - May 2025):

- Co-teaching analytics course to class of 50 students, overseeing assignments and examinations.
- Cultivating an analytic mindset and communicating statistical theory and practice.
- Includes workshops on statistical programming in R and JASP software for analysis.

Project Coordinator - Global Behavioral Science (GLOBES) (April 2022 - Aug 2022):

- Led the analysis teams for two related multi-country studies on financial decision-making.
- Created and curated analysis pipelines, built two high-impact policy relevant manuscripts.
- Utilised high levels of statistical knowledge and fluent data-wrangling skills.

University of Oxford - Graduate Teacher *Oct 2020 - Oct 2023*

Lab Demonstrator (Oct 2020 - Oct 2023):

- Assisted core practical demonstrations and marking coursework.
- Graded coursework, supervised classwork, and helped students understand the learning outcomes.
- *Courses:* Perception, Development, Individual Differences, Social Psych, Ethics, & Qual Methods.

Teaching Assistant (Oct 2022 - Dec 2022):

- Assisted on the graduate course “Quantitative Methods” for MSc in Experimental Anthropology.
- Course content focused on learning the skills of Statistical Programming in R.
- Assisted students during class, held weekly office hours, and supported the course leader throughout.

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant (Oct 2020 - Dec 2022):

- Supervised group tutorials to formally support lectures for the undergraduate “Cognition” course.
- Explored course content, taught essay writing skills, and developed understanding of complex topics.
- Adjusted teaching style to suit the needs of the students and their learning goals.

Polaris & Dawn International - Educational Consultant

Jun 2018 - Nov 2023

Education Consultant

- Provided tailored mentorship for students aiming for international educational paths.
- Specialisms include personalised Psychology & Biology tuition, and academic English support.
- Curated university application support, interview preparation, and technical editing services.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Junior Researcher Programme

Oct 2019 - Present

Executive Director

- Leading a global organisation working to create opportunities for early career researchers.
- Secured new institutional partnerships establishing sustainable cross-university collaboration models.
- Manage 6 ECR research teams, and one large-scale cross-border project, across 13-month program.
- Execute funding budget, lead team of 15, and iterate annual calendar of international events.

Framework for Open and Reproducible Research Training

Dec 2024 - Present

Director of Sustainability & Strategy

- Strategic reimagining of open science infrastructure via multi-stakeholder governance models.
- Structuring a multi-layer funding pipeline to ensure the sustainable growth of community research.
- Organisational support for projects relating to replication science and open pedagogy.

SERVICE

Academic Journals

Oct 2023 - Present

Peer Reviewer

- Serve as an ad hoc peer reviewer for multiple journals, providing commentary insight to the editors.
- Journals reviewed span the Journal of Financial Services Marketing and Teaching Psychology.

The Forum on Education Abroad

Sept 2025 - Present

Faculty Reviewer

- Served as a faculty reviewer for the 2025 Award for Academic Achievement Abroad.
- Assessed student contributions and potential for future research.

Reproducible Research Oxford

Oct 2020 - Nov 2023

RROx Fellow

- Supporting local Open Science initiatives, leading lectures and groups, and building community.
- Established a long-running bookclub for skill acquisition and ECR community engagement.
- Gave annual MRC DTP open science lecture.

ReproducibiliTea

Oct 2019 - Nov 2023

Oxford Local Lead

- Organising the regular reproducibiliTea journal club: leading local sessions and workshops.
- Building term cards of journal club sessions and acquiring local funding for the initiative.
- Leading team and creating community among ECRs.